

makefile which was created when you executed the **configure** script while installing the software, you will be able to remove any software in similar fashion that you had installed yourself by compiling from source. In case for some reasons you have deleted the makefile, you will have to remove the program files manually.

If you know where the program was installed, you'll have to manually delete the installed files. This is one of the disadvantages of building each software from source individually, instead of using a package manager.

3.4 Advanced compile options

Now if you feel slightly comfortable with the shell and the process of compiling software from source code, here are few tips and tweaks to optimise the compilation process.

One compiler flag to watch out for in the Makefile is **-g** (as in **gcc -g**). The GNU programs often have this flag, which instructs the compiler to add bulky debugging code to the executable. This is needed if you plan to use a debugger on the program. If you are reading this, then there is an over 99 per cent chance that you will never need to use a debugger on that code. So you can safely remove it by editing the makefile manually.

Some other configure options to look for are **configure --help**. This will produce a verbose output of guess what? Help!

The next configure options is **Configure --prefix=dir**. This will instruct Configure to install programs and files under directory **dir**. This can be very helpful if you want to keep your installed programs which you have compiled from source in a separate partition than the ones installed by your package manager.

For instance, to install “digit” software from the example above in the **/usr/local** directory (away from other software and easier to maintain), use **--prefix=/usr/local**.

If you really know what you are doing, or have done what you are doing a million times before, you can use **Configure --quiet** command. This suppresses the check messages.

Now, if you really want to extract the last bit of juice and are ready to get your hands dirty in the process, you can set the **CFLAGS** (for C code) and **CXXFLAGS** (for C++) environment